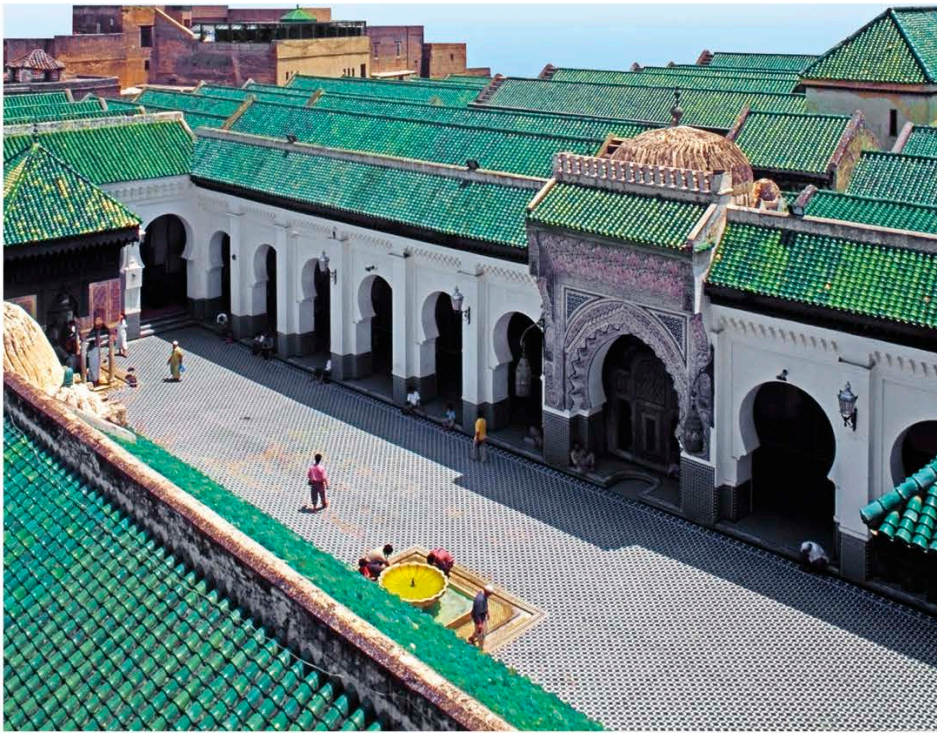
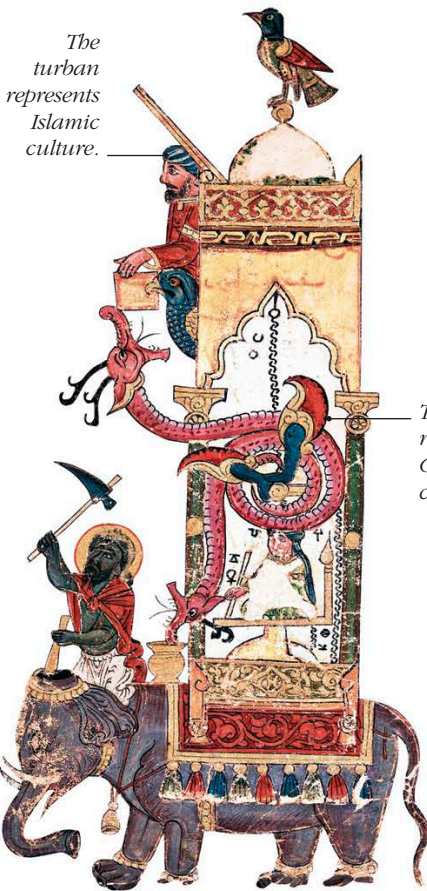




▲ UNIVERSITY OF QARAWIYYIN

The Islamic Empire established some of the world's earliest universities. In 859, Fatima Al-Fibri founded the Al-Qarawiyyin mosque in Fez, Morocco, which became a top center of Islamic learning. The complex included a prayer space, courtyard, library, and school rooms. It is considered to be the oldest university in the world.



▲ THE ELEPHANT CLOCK

Engineer Ismail al-Jazari (1136–1206) invented the "Elephant Clock" which used the flow of water between bowls to measure time. A tank was hidden in the belly of the elephant where water poured from one basin to another. The design represents the diversity of cultures in Islam.

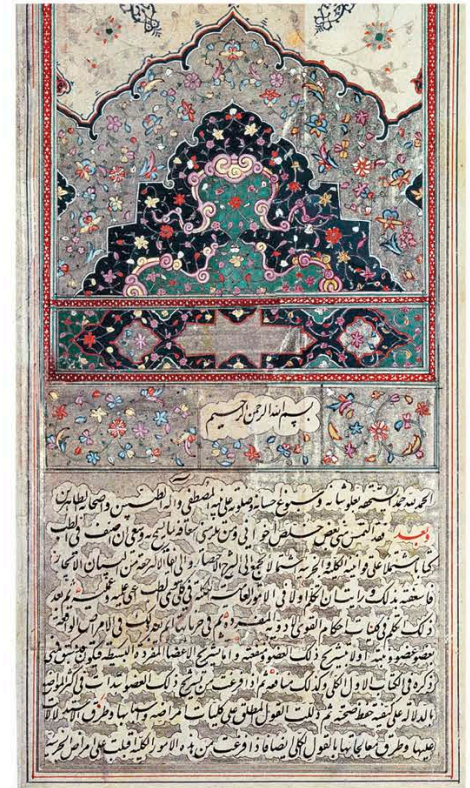


▲ ASTRONOMY

Scientists in the Islamic world were very interested in astronomy. They developed astrolabes to calculate the position of the sun and stars. These devices were used to tell the time and they could also indicate the direction of Mecca, which Muslims must face toward for prayer.

▼ CANON OF MEDICINE

In the 11th century, Persian physician Ibn Sina, also known as Avicenna, wrote an encyclopedia of medicine—the Canon of Medicine—which was used as a medical textbook for more than 700 years. It included information on how our bodies work and the causes of health and illness.



OMAR KHAYYAM

Omar Khayyam (1048–1131), was born during the reign of the Seljuks. The Persian mathematician, astronomer, philosopher, and poet is known for his contribution to math and for his "Rubáiyát"—a collection of quatrains (four-line poems) about the different stages of life, including love, loss, and death.

